

JAIDEEP PHATAK, PMP®

Project & Technical Program Manager | Automotive OEM & Tier-1 | Portfolio Governance | AI-Augmented Delivery

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Professional Summary

Automotive program manager with 10+ years of experience, including 7+ years directing VAVE, benchmarking, and cross-functional programs across OEM and Tier-1 supplier environments in APAC, EU, and North America. Managed 35+ programs across cumulative portfolios of \$8M–\$10M+ with 80+ engineers across multiple regions simultaneously, with direct CXO-level steering committee accountability. Proven track record of delivering programs from initiation through delivery. Delivered \$200/vehicle in cost savings and achieved a 40% reduction in programme cycle times through structured VAVE, engineering change governance, and process standardisation. Combining domain depth with AI-enabled reporting, Power BI dashboards, and Lean Six Sigma execution to drive programme excellence.

Key Achievements

- \$200/vehicle cost savings delivered through structured VAVE and engineering change programs across mid-size SUV, ICE, and BEV platforms
- \$8M–\$10M+ cumulative portfolio governance across 35+ OEM programs (Trucks, SUVs, EVs, BEV) with 95%+ on-time delivery through NPD Stage-Gate governance, Gate Reviews, and RAID management
- 80+ engineers led cross-functionally across the USA, UAE, and India with direct CXO steering committee reporting
- ~20kg/vehicle weight reduction alongside cost savings through VAVE, DFA/DFM analysis, and engineering change execution
- 40% reduction in programme cycle times (20–24 weeks to 12–14 weeks) and First Time Right quality improvement from ~50% to ~90% through SOP standardisation, structured onboarding, and process redesign

Professional Experience

Project Manager

Oct 2025 – May 2026

Caresoft Technologies LLC OPC | Ras Al Khaimah, UAE

- **OEM Technical Program Lead:** Served as primary program liaison for global OEMs in the US, EU, and APAC time zones overseeing platform onboarding, training delivery, and application engineering
- **Sales & Pre-Sales Support:** Led technical demonstrations and regional trial programs for Global OEM and Tier-1 & Tier-2 suppliers; collaborated with global sales teams during pre-sales engagements
- **Cross-Functional Governance:** Evaluated tool development ideas, coordinated with engineering and product teams on requirement lifecycle tracking from submission through implementation
- **Quality & Compliance:** Conducted on-site physical compliance audits across UAE; maintained audit logs and issued corrective action reports

Project Manager

Apr 2024 – Sep 2025

Caresoft Global Technologies | Livonia, Michigan, USA

- **Portfolio Governance:** Managed 35+ Automotive Benchmarking programs (Trucks, SUVs, EVs) across cumulative portfolios of \$8M–\$10M+; achieved 95%+ on-time delivery through NPD Stage-Gate governance, Gate Reviews, RAID management, and steering committee reporting
- **Global Team Leadership:** Directed 80+ engineers across the USA, UAE, and India; designed scalable PMO delivery frameworks that reduced programme cycle times by 40% and improved rework rates and overall throughput
- **Executive Reporting & Analytics:** Built KPI dashboards in Power BI and Excel; integrated GenAI workflows to automate project status synthesis, reducing manual reporting effort
- **Budget & Cost Governance:** Owned resource utilisation planning, cost forecasting, and budget governance across the full portfolio aligned to business objectives
- **Process Standards:** Established NPD stage-gate reviews, APQP/PPAP milestone tracking, DFMEA coordination, Jira workflow governance, engineering change control procedures, and SLA compliance frameworks across all programmes

Senior VAVE Engineer

Jul 2023 – Apr 2024

Caresoft Global Technologies | Livonia, Michigan, USA

- **Cost & Value Engineering:** Identified and delivered ~\$200/vehicle cost savings and ~20kg/vehicle weight reduction across mid-size SUV, ICE, and BEV programs through structured VAVE analysis and engineering change execution
- **Business Case Development:** Built ROI models and cost-benefit analyses to justify improvement proposals; tracked realised savings against baseline targets post-implementation
- **Lean Six Sigma Execution:** Applied DMAIC methodology to eliminate waste, reduce cycle times, and drive process standardisation across engineering and procurement teams
- **Stakeholder Coordination:** Coordinated global teams across engineering, costing, DFA/DFM, procurement, and supplier partners for cost reduction programs with full engineering change control

Project Manager

Jan 2023 – Jun 2023

Caresoft Global Technologies | Livonia, Michigan, USA

- Managed benchmarking driven automotive NPD programmes (5,000-10,000 hours) with budgets up to \$1.5M across Full Size and Mid-Size Trucks, SUVs, EVs, achieving 95% on-time delivery through MS Project scheduling, NPD Stage-Gate governance, and Gate Reviews
- Led Agile Scrum ceremonies and Six Sigma-driven productivity improvements, achieving 30-50% line productivity gains
- Piloted GenAI tools to automate KPI tracking and team performance reporting, reducing manual effort by 10%

Automotive Benchmarking Analyst

Jun 2019 – Dec 2022

Caresoft Global Technologies | Livonia, Michigan, USA

- Led on-site data acquisition and operations for Full Size and Mid-Size pick-up trucks, SUVs, and EVs, coordinating between PMs, engineering, and global stakeholders across 3 regions
- Developed version-controlled SOPs and onboarding standards across 6 global facilities; improved First Time Right quality from ~75% to ~90% and reduced operational waste by 20%
- Participated in VA/VE idea generation and review sessions; coordinated with SMEs to produce OEM cost-saving proposals

Core Competencies

VAVE & Cost Engineering | Program & Portfolio Governance | Engineering Change Management | Lean Six Sigma (DMAIC) | New Product Development (NPD) | NPD Stage-Gate & Gate Reviews | APQP / PPAP | DFMEA | Product Lifecycle Management (PLM) | Power BI & KPI Dashboards | OEM Customer Management | Cross-Functional Team Leadership | Risk Identification & Mitigation | Agile / Waterfall / Hybrid Delivery | Budget & Cost Control | Process Standardisation

Tools & Platforms

MS Project | Jira | Confluence | Power BI | Excel (Advanced) | SAP (exposure) | SharePoint | Monday.com | Asana | Google Workspace | GenAI (Claude, Copilot, ChatGPT, Gemini)

Education

Master of Science, Mechanical Engineering

2017 – 2018

Lamar University, Beaumont, Texas, USA | GPA: 3.54 / 4.0

Bachelor of Engineering, Mechanical Engineering

Savitribai Phule Pune University, Pune, India

Certifications

- PMP® – Project Management Professional (Project Management Institute)
- AI for Project Management (LinkedIn Learning)
- Lean Six Sigma Green Belt (LSSGB) - Udemy